DESIGN THINKING ROADMAP

From a broad challenge to a testable solution

Mass-affluent wealth advice | Innovation School 2026

1. Understand
2. Empathize
3. Ideate
4. Prototype
5. Business Case

Core principle: agree on the problem before choosing the solution.

Draft for team alignment - not a final solution proposal

What are we really trying to design?

A service level between generic retail guidance and full private banking

How can we give customers with higher income or savings a level of guidance that is more valuable than generic retail guidance, but still cheaper and more scalable than full private banking?

Generic retail

Education, product information, self-service tools and broad guidance.

Useful, but may not be enough for more complex goals.

Our design space

Affordable guidance, clearer decisions, assisted digital support and human help at the moments that matter.

Private banking

High-touch, dedicated advisers and deeper planning.

Valuable, but too costly to provide at scale to everyone.

This is a positioning statement - not yet the final customer problem.

The sequence matters

We should not agree on a solution first



Agree on the problem

Who? Which market? Which moment?
What evidence shows a real difficulty?
Why does it matter?

Then choose a solution

Generate several options, compare them, choose one assumption to test, and change direction if the evidence says so.

Too early: “Our solution is an AI chatbot.”

1. Understand

Agree on the scope and the current journey before solving anything

1 Understand

Questions to answer

- Which market are we studying?
- Which mass-affluent subgroup?
- What service do they receive today?
- Where in the journey could friction exist?
- What is fact vs assumption?

What we bring

- Official challenge
- Veljko expert interview
- Public bank/service examples
- Existing investment journey knowledge
- Data or expert evidence we can access

Output / decision gate

A provisional customer + market + journey map + top unanswered questions.

Only then do we move deeper into customer evidence.

Do not choose the app, AI, chatbot or platform here.

2. Empathize & Synthesize

Turn assumptions into evidence and one focused problem

2 **Empathize & Synthesize**

Listen to real experiences

Customer: “Tell me about the last time you had savings and needed to decide what to do.”

Banker: “Where does a real customer usually get stuck, and what takes most time?”

Look for patterns

Cluster needs, frustrations, workarounds and contradictions. Separate observed evidence from our interpretation.

Output / decision gate

One focused problem statement + 2-3 evidence-backed insights + a “How might we…?” question.

This is the point where we should be able to explain WHY the problem is worth solving.

3. Ideate

Now - and only now - do we decide what kind of solution to explore

3 **Ideate**

Clearer explanation

One-page recommendation rationale

Human handover

Carry context into banker support

Wealth health check

Help prioritize the next financial action

Guided journey

Reduce drop-off from intent to completion

Education

Short lessons before decision points

AI assistant

Only if evidence shows it solves a real gap

Choose based on customer relevance, evidence, feasibility, operating cost and advisory responsibilities.

4. Prototype & Test

Test the riskiest assumption with the smallest useful prototype

4 **Prototype & Test**

Prototype examples

- Paper screens
- One-page explanation
- Banker handover summary
- Role-play
- Goal-review dashboard

No full platform needed.

What to observe

Can the customer complete the task?
What do they misunderstand?
Where do they still need help?
What changes after feedback?

Output / decision gate

Evidence that the idea helps - or evidence that we should change it.

A failed assumption is useful learning.

Testing is not “Do you like our idea?” - it is watching whether the idea actually helps.

5. Business Case & Pitch

Explain customer value, delivery reality and the next pilot

5 **Business Case & Pitch**

Customer value

Does the customer understand the choice?
Reach a useful next action?
Get help without repeating everything?
Know when to review?

Bank / operating value

Adviser time saved
Fewer repeated contacts
Higher completion
Better use of existing capabilities
Potential relationship value

Pitch / next step

Problem → evidence → concept → test learning → cost/benefit → uncertainties → small pilot ask.

Our job is not to defend the first idea. Our job is to learn our way to a credible solution.

What should we agree as a team first?

A practical discussion checklist for Budapest

1. **Market + customer** — Who exactly are we trying to help?
2. **Journey moment** — Where does the experience break down?
3. **Evidence** — What have we actually observed or heard?
4. **Problem** — Why is this worth solving?
5. **Only then: solution** — Which idea is the best one to test first?

Recommendation for the meeting: use the first deck to align on the challenge, then use this roadmap to agree how the team will work through it.